Dane Bonnigson

The Tech Translator · AI Training & Enablement · Technology Integration · L&D
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Tech Translator who turns technology resistance into measurable team performance. Led a full school staff from 0% to 86% daily AI use in 15 months, saving the staff 12+ hours a week combined, and now trains teams and builds AI tools as founder of PalmettoGroup.AI. 21 years in education, 8 years leading staff, MBA and M.Ed. in Classroom Technology. Open to remote or Upstate SC roles.

CORE SKILLS

AI Training & Enablement | AI Tool Integration & Adoption | Change Management | Curriculum & Training Design | Professional Development Delivery | LMS Administration & EdTech | Data Dashboards & KPI Tracking | Vendor Evaluation & Platform Rollout | Strategic Planning & Turnaround | Stakeholder Communication | People Management & Development | AI Quality Checks & Guardrails

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder, AI and Business Consulting | PalmettoGroup.AI | Aug 2025 – Present

- **Workplace Safety Training (client).** A fire-safety company needed pre-class training. Delivered three e-learning courses checked against OSHA 29 CFR 1910.157(g) and 1910.38.
- **Decision Desk (AI agent).** Leads from SAM.gov, Grants.gov, web research and inbound messages were too many to review by hand. Built an agent that scores each lead with a confidence level; code makes the final call and low-confidence cases go to a person. Reused the engine to screen job postings.
- **EDITRON (AI product).** Needed a faster way to turn raw recordings into finished videos. Built an AI editor that makes the cuts and renders captions, chapters and shorts, with guardrails: one-folder access, nothing posts without review, bystanders' faces blurred. In use through 20+ releases.
- **Market Review & SEO Audit (client).** A young local service company didn't know where it stood online. Delivered a graded SEO scorecard, eight-competitor review and 90-day plan, with every finding sourced.
- **3 iPhone apps on the App Store:** Gains in Progress (fitness tracking), F3 Q Sheet (workout planning for F3 leaders) and NowNext (to-do list sorted by energy level).

Principal | Western Reserve Middle School, Collins, OH | Jul 2023 – Aug 2025

- Drove AI tool adoption from 0% awareness to 86% daily use across staff in 15 months through structured training and ongoing professional development, saving the staff 12+ hours a week combined; built the curriculum and support docs, shared AI tools I built, and advocated for AI use with upper administration; the program was modeled for district-wide AI rollout planning.
- Raised a bottom-5% school to mid-level standing, reaching state average within two years (Ohio School Report Cards); state test scores rose 18%.
- Achieved 99.98% completion across 86,779 assignments with a school-wide tracking and accountability system.
- Cut student failure rates 67% through data-driven intervention systems and structured tutoring.
- Managed the full IXL rollout from pilot through district-wide implementation, including vendor selection, contracts, onboarding and staff training on the platform and its data; contributed to the 18% state test score improvement.
- Cut major discipline 55% with a school-wide behavior matrix and tracking; IEP discipline referrals down 79%, IEP state test pass rates up 9%.
- Built a district-wide master schedule: staff collaboration time up 40%, maximum class sizes down 18%; cut student missed class time 50% with a location management system.

Virtual Learning Academy Coordinator | Woodmore Schools, Elmore, OH | Jul 2017 – Jun 2023

- Scaled K-12 online learning from 100 to 1,000 students by identifying and implementing a vendor solution.
- Supervised the grading teachers, including handling their pay; trained all staff and graders on the LMS with ongoing professional development and technical support.
- Reduced recurring help requests by building troubleshooting websites and support documentation for staff self-service.

- Kept graduation above 93% (state report card Grade A) every year; built a live Excel dashboard that surfaced student progress to stakeholders in real time.
- Saved the district $20,000 by sourcing a distance learning alternative for opt-out learners.
- Resolved a labor negotiation impasse by designing a compensation model that secured a 3-year contract.

Teacher, Computing, Business, History & Communication | Woodmore Schools, Elmore, OH | 2004 – 2017

- Created 20+ courses integrating technology platforms, project-based assessments and performance data tracking; taught Adobe Creative Suite, CSS, HTML and Python.

Co-Founder & Head of Go-to-Market | The Dogwood Company, LLC, Bowling Green, OH | Oct 2017 – May 2022

- Co-founded a skincare product line; led market research, competitive analysis, product positioning and pricing models; managed LLC formation, retail contracts and vendor coordination.

EDUCATION

M.B.A., Business Administration — Bowling Green State University (2016)
M.Ed., Classroom Technology, Computer Science Endorsement — Bowling Green State University (2009)
Educational Administration Licensure — Bowling Green State University (2019)
B.S., Education, Communication / History — Eastern Michigan University (2004)

CERTIFICATIONS & LICENSES

AI-Powered Data Analysis (University of Michigan) · Generative AI for BI Analysts (IBM) · Google Data Analytics Professional · Professional Google Workspace Administrator (Google Cloud) · Gemini for Google Workspace (Google Cloud) · Ohio Principal Licensure, Grades 4–12 · Ohio Teaching Licensure: Computer/Technology K–12 with CS Endorsement, Communication & History

HONORS & RECOGNITION

- Top 15% nationally, Capsim MBA business simulation, for strategic and financial performance
- Honored Educator: selected to attend the Top 10% and 9-to-5 Recognition Banquets; peer-voted "Walking Wikipedia"
- Four-year Division I varsity wrestler, Eastern Michigan University; 20 years of coaching (wrestling, robotics, track, volleyball)